

Thank you for your interest in Oxide!

At Oxide, we are taking a big swing: rethinking the definition of the server-side computer, combining the wisdom of hyperscaler systems with the energy of the open data center -- and delivering it as a product.

We are looking for people who share our mission.

Our most deeply held technical belief is in the integration of hardware and software: we believe that the best and most reliable infrastructure comes when hardware and software are designed to work with one another. We are looking for technologists who share this worldview and are excited to build a product that combines hardware and software. If it needs to be said, this isn't easy!

We are looking for people who like to solve hard problems.

At Oxide, our values are deeply important to us — so much so that we make them explicit and refer to them frequently:

Candor	Diversity	Optimism	Rigor	Transparency
Courage	Empathy	Resilience	Teamwork	Urgency
Curiosity	Humor	Responsibility	Thriftiness	Versatility

We are looking for people who share our values.

Our hiring process is a little different than most: we believe that the best basis for assessment of a person is not through their performance on an arbitrary oral exam, but rather through their own expression. That is, we choose to use interviews not to assess you as a stranger, but rather to more deeply understand the complete person who your work indicates you to be.

You should find that these candidate materials will take no more than a couple of hours to gather; please make a copy of this document and for each section, please use the space provided, expanding into additional pages as necessary. When completed, please export this document as a PDF and submit it with your application.

Work samples

Successful technical product marketing is measured in the enablement of others: helping the market understand how a solution makes their life easier, reducing the friction to user adoption, and supporting sales teams as they work with customers. Please describe **at least two** examples of product marketing efforts you have led, from user research through content creation, and the impact of this work. If proprietary, please describe it as fully as you can, providing necessary context.

Work sample(s)

I will try to elaborate on a limited number of cases/projects to keep the reader in the context for most questions.

CloudMade Experience Car - technology show-car

[CloudMade](#) was planning to revolutionize human-car interaction by making a truly “smart” car - (in retrospect, think what chatGPT did for ML/AI) gather enough user-data to understand lifestyle patterns and make the car understand you and assist you on your daily drives, not randomly send you push notifications with features you never use, or even understand.

I joined CloudMade as a hardware and fleet innovation manager (we struggled with that job name a lot!) in the wider product management team.

On the onset, the job was very open-ended and challenging, we needed to a) hack the MQB VW to gather data, b) build the ML inferences to create useful predictions, and c) be able to demo them on-the-fly in moving car on client’s grounds with a neat sales pitch.

Our moonshot idea was to close the gap between car manufacturer’s (OEMs) perception of their users and actual needs of drivers like you and me.

We built an interactive demo car, which carried both input and output for our intelligent system. Input - we wired into car’s CANBUS and it allowed us to gather route, driving and user data from both native car sensors and additional telematic computer; Output - it allowed us to showcase real-time predictions and route adjustments on car head unit.

I’ve bought and built 5 of such cars (USA, 2xEurope, Ukraine and Japan), so that we could drive to OEMs HQs, build predictions on real routes around their offices (think Wolfsburg for VW or Tokyo for Toyota) and give rides to corporate decision makers.

Professionally, I was at the intersection of product development (as I was setting up the car’s hardware, software and mobile apps and making sure it works as we wanted remote sites) and

Oxide Candidate Materials: Product Marketing

sales and marketing (as I was part of marketing effort to OEMs, setting up events, writing pitches and doing demo-drives with clients), taking part in all demo drives, preparing the routes, QAing the product demo and working with engineering, building the sales narrative to deliver it during the drives. I spent my time at 2017 CES honing a narrative which explained why a connected car is a *better* car for *the driver*, and it had great response, we've landed several \$1m+ contracts thanks to the showcar.

Beyond that, I've hired and built a team of fleet managers, which could later support the new demo cars and products for CloudMade, so that I could leave for my next career chapter.

For me, this experience was both extremely rewarding and partially traumatic, as it was a 24/7 head spinning worldwide adventure into the land of automotive. My software/hardware/sales holistic experience gives me perspective, which I see useful in Oxide's world.

Ring Radar-powered Camera

At Ring Research, our vision was to make neighborhoods safer by transforming the traditional doorbell into a security powerhouse. In a world where home security was often seen as complex and intimidating, Ring aimed to simplify it, making it accessible and user-friendly for every homeowner.

I joined Ring as a program manager and innovations leader for sensor research, and I knew nearly nothing about radars when I joined.

The role was very intrapreneurial, as our team task was to look for innovative ways to use sensors for IoT and home security and we've spent a notable chunk of time trying different sensor types (infrared, sonars, lidars, radars, etc) in all kinds of scenarios, and understanding the challenge homeowners face with *conventional (Computer Vision)* cameras. Our hypothesis was that radar will bring an unexpected twist to home safety, while increasing privacy, as non-CV sensors didn't fall-back to facial recognition.

After a wide-seed test of sensors and applications, we narrowed our choice to radar as a desired sensor and three most cutting edge vendors as suppliers.

The challenges were multifaceted: a) understand the diverse needs of homeowners, b) effectively communicate the benefits of a premium camera doorbell, and c) to drive adoption in a market dominated by traditional security systems.

Beyond that, we were also rallying internally in Ring and Amazon, as we had to "innovate" our way into production and prove that radar, our radar is the thing to put next couple of years and millions of development dollars into (as opposed to competing ideas, improvements or extensions to existing products).

Our strategic goal was to deeply understand our users. Through extensive user research, surveys, and feedback loops, we identified key pain points in modern security systems, including existing CV solutions (both Ring and competitors). Our solution was actually enhancing the camera in its weakest points - low visibility and high interference situations (e.g. snowfalls, winds, recurring motion objects). In the process of research and product development we came to a conclusion, that [other] humans are the ultimate "threat" in home security situations and that identifying people among all other possible objects and triggers is the P0 of any home surveillance and privacy system. Radar gave an upper hand in that - it allowed homeowners to identify people as point clouds *without* sacrificing their privacy!

I crafted narratives and use cases that resonated with our homeowners audience and internal decision makers. When our CEO was visiting our office, with help of Hardware Design department and Firmware team, my companion engineering manager and I created a live demo of the radar capabilities compared to the usual camera: we brought a camera on a tripod into

Oxide Candidate Materials: Product Marketing

the lobby, threw some pieces of plastic grass onto the floor in random places and made camera only react to me, when I was standing on the patches of grass, completely ignoring me otherwise. This was a simple demo of CVs weak spots.

My work on radar was mostly pre Go-To-Market, and I covered many bases for the program, engaged with user insights team, product tests and integration testing, worked with hardware, firmware and software teams to create working prototypes and ensure we build a great product for our users, no matter how challenging it would be to create.

In the end, our effort resulted in a radar-powered doorbell, which sold around 800k units, the team we built became Ring's go-to for sensors and as far as I know they still work on bleeding edge features for Ring.

Writing samples

Writing is an essential part of engaging with the market and is something that we rely heavily on at Oxide to stay connected and consistent while often working apart.

What's an example of product- or market-oriented writing that you are proud of? This writing can take a variety of forms, e.g.:

- A detailed product description
- A blog entry or other long-form post
- A customer use case
- Product materials supporting sales training
- End-user documentation
- Market segment analysis
- Customer persona analysis

Please submit at least one writing sample (and no more than three) that you feel represents you, providing links if/as necessary.

Writing sample(s)

In my time at Ring Research Infrastructure, I wrote the tenets for our team, after a short discussion session. This short piece received a lot of positive feedback. My goal is to balance out the human-ness of my writing with the clarity of business writing.

1. **Storm shelter.** We strive to onboard services without Amazon owners, give them home, clean and heal their wounds, build mechanisms and find new owners for the service, when time comes.
2. **Tight-fit Costume Rental.** We only provide minimal access rights and roles required to do the job. We trim extraneous rights, limit blast radius and review access expiry dates.
3. **Man vs Machine.** We choose machines over humans for access. We gravitate towards programmatic access (be it long-term or ad-hoc) with logging and policy guardrails. We trust humans, but we know that they're just humans (and that's fine).
4. **Slight inconvenience of a 500kg safe door.** We consciously choose privacy over convenience. We go the extra mile to weave convenience and UX into our processes and routines. But the door is a door and we respect it.
5. **(Bulletproof Plexi-)Glass castle.** While we value privacy, security and discreteness above else, we build transparent procedures and thought trains for our services and team. We have a lot to protect, but nothing to hide.

Oxide Candidate Materials: Product Marketing

6. **Rhizome.** While we're at the wind rose, we are part of a greater network of teams and services, and we enable and delegate work to other teams and build trust in the long term. We both seek help and are able to provide it.

7. **Techno-poets.** We strive to describe and write down events and patterns we observe, we leave a paper trail of narratives, questions and how-to guides. We document the undocumented and note the unnoticed. We broke many pens. We will break many more.

I would also suggest using my other answers as my writing style samples, this is my style of thought and communication most of the time (unless I need to put on some kind of formal hat).

Market analysis sample

Steve Jobs famously observed in his 1997 WWDC keynote that “focusing is about saying ‘no’”, and there are few areas where this is more acutely felt than product marketing: a significant challenge is determining the highest-impact areas to focus on and how to identify and best approach the key constituents (champions, influencers, decision makers, buyers, etc.). This is made more challenging by the ever-evolving nature of a product’s capabilities and constant changes in the market. Please provide an example where you have arrived at a determination for market focus, including the research undertaken to arrive at that conclusion. If the work was proprietary, please describe in as much detail as you can.

Market analysis sample(s)

I don’t have access to my notes and precise numbers from the time, so I’ll do my best to write out the story and use estimates from my memory.

At Ring I was leading a program for a feature called “Motion Settings 2.0,” which would ultimately do two major things: 1. internally: unify Ring’s battery- and wired-powered device architecture to use the same logic across all back- and front-end units and 2. Externally, customer-facing: unify interfaces for all cameras and recording settings, letting the user to separately set recording and notifications toggles (e.g. you could ask camera to record everything, but not notify you, as opposed to discarding the recordings).

Main quirk was that we needed to decide what settings to transpose to new logic, so that if we update your 3 cameras, we can’t directly copy your settings - what settings you should get and whether additional communication is required for this (pop-up, notes, emails).

We analyzed that total Ring user base was at around 40m devices (total users were less than that, as people owned multiple devices) and then we sliced those in Looker/Tableau to see what devices would be a) obsolete and EOled by the time we launch, b) bought and installed by the time we launch our roll-out waves, c) having issues for a variety of reasons, firmware faults, being turned off and so on.

Then, we went into understanding people’s usecases, and the most critical setting would be People-Only Mode, as it was a complete deal maker/breaker. As we understood (previously during Radar Research) is that humans are the ultimate threat in the world of home surveillance, that possibility of a wild animal, tornado, fallen tree or a car being a “hazard” to your home security is times less than a human walking towards your door.

Oxide Candidate Materials: Product Marketing

What we also understood that you would tolerate many false positives (e.g. extraneous notification for waving flag), but it's absolutely critical to never have even single false negatives (e.g. sketchy person standing in front of your door or making some marks on your porch).

Afterwards, we spliced the user base into 1m slices, split them into roll-out waves, asked GTM to be ready to communicate in waves and started rolling out in waves 1m/day. It had its drama, errors and Correction Of Errors, but in the end it was a total rollout and everyone was happy (corporate "happy") in the end.

Questionnaire

Please answer the following questions, using as much space as you need. All of these questions are important, but the final question is probably the most important one; take your time in answering it!

What work have you found most technically challenging in your career and why?

Hard to choose, somehow I always found myself in technically challenging environments, as it required me to quickly get into very technical terms sometimes without enough background and/or education on the topic. I started with automotive, and I liked cars as a concept, but I was tasked with helping to reverse-engineer VW CANBUS with the help of C++ engineers and QAs, splice into the car and help build the solution, so I had to be quick on my research. Then Radars came, then AWS infra, now it's Speech Recognition and LLMs (but I feel cold about them). Reframing the question - I like to be technically challenged a bit, but I need to be interested in the topic/domain, otherwise it saps energy over time.

What work have you done that you were particularly proud of and why?

I'm very proud of the fleet and team I built at CloudMade, as I was the backbone of a worldwide operation, with cars being shown to execs and VPs at multiple locations simultaneously, and I was the one to orchestrate it. It sounded very massive for a 1-man job, now I know I was severely underpaid and undervalued, but this warms during cold winter evening of no motivation.

When have you been happiest in your professional career and why?

My radar times were extremely interesting and happy, while being challenging enough. We were an innovation startup inside a corporation - I had a team I could trust and respect. We had a very ambitious and interesting goal, no guarantee or clear path to success, but resources and support on all levels. I felt as a CEO of a yet small, but very ambitious business affair.

I also had a galaxy of problems to solve: buy an anechoic chamber and bring it to Ukraine, make a 500 camera data collection, hack existing FW/HW to make a radar prototype. I had a perpetual inner conflict, as I'm not a fan of IoT and even less a supporter of mass surveillance solutions (which Ring borderline is). But I had my oasis of greatness.

It was extremely challenging at the time, but I did a lot to keep the team together, keep them motivated and move forward together. I both empowered to lead and lead, that was a ride to remember <3

When have you been unhappiest in your professional career and why?

Oxide Candidate Materials: Product Marketing

My unhappiest times in my career are now, in Amazon Alexa ASR, I sold this to myself as a temporary decision, but this has been a complete value mismatch. Enterprise-heavy, corporate-bowing, detached from real users and real problems, completely questionable product, with hoard of managers looking at metrics in Excel for days, trying to deliver on goals, thrown from the top, I felt hurt for some time, but now I'm moving forward with no bad blood. This is layered with the war in Ukraine, which deeply touched my world and my family, and took a toll on me during the last years. The inability of the corporate environment and people in corporate boundaries to say and act according to their values and beliefs made my time here a hurt locker.

Beyond that, I truly liked and respected Amazon's LPs as guiding principles and "synchronization" beacons for people and processes, but last year RTO and lay-offs clearly showed a disconnect between the declared values and the actual ones. It's a sad lesson, but I hope I learnt it.

For one of Oxide's values, describe an example of how it was reflected in a particular body of your work.

I like most of them, but I'll pick Versatility to tell my story. We needed 1000 hours of data collected from radars and cameras, and we needed those in US-street environments, as neither Ukrainian, nor EU streets would train the models well for the US environment. We didn't have US-side operations team and budget, so we just shipped 100 cameras with custom firmwares to the US and ordered 100 radar boards.

As we didn't have operations and my team didn't have US-visas, it was a 1-man-army situation, where I traveled to our Santa Monica office, took 100 cameras, tripods and radar boards, assembled prototypes, flashed firmwares, screwed in tripods and asked local trials team to distribute that to our data collection participants. It was out of my paygrade and my job description, but I felt absolutely responsible to make things happen for the radar camera to happen. My connection with the team and the goal trumped inner whispers and conflicts.

For one of Oxide's values, describe an example of how it was violated in your organization or work.

For my times at Ring, transparency and teamwork were violated regularly. As Ring was growing and being assimilated into Amazon, a lot of powerplay and political competition kicked in. People would not say what they honestly think, statements were not what they stated, but had a second bottom most of the time. During inter-continental discussions, people would use their "corporate" personas and say all the right things, while proceeding to do what would move their agenda forward. Especially it hurt when various office locations would compete for power and influence and mildly drown or sabotage the success of other teams. I'm pretty sure it's an

Oxide Candidate Materials: Product Marketing

inevitable “process” of chaos, but I strongly believe it’s higher management’s critical job to actively trim these weeds of collective existence.

For a pair of Oxide's values, describe a time in which the two values came into tension for you or your work, and how you resolved it.

I’ll tell you about an experience when Empathy and Rigor came into conflict during late stage of our radar venture. We hired a team of very talented engineers, who excelled at anything technical you would throw at them, however they were extremely immature and harsh towards people, not as “high-performing” or “talented” as they were.

I spent a notable amount of my time and energy being the team therapist and soul shaman, building candor, respect, fighting bullying (while keeping the actual performance and knowledge bar high). I really spent a lot of time in 1on1s with that engineer and took measures to address all the pain points they had.

I was conflicted, as I both needed such talent, as we had a mission:impossible task in front of us. At the same time, it was unacceptable for me to work in a toxic, disrespectful environment, where only stars flourish.

With a heavy heart, my engineering manager and I fired the engineer, who was invisibly attacking or mildly bullying others, even though they were our top talent. And you know what, as soon as toxicity went away - people started working better, team started to be more coherent and predictability of successes went up.

It was a painful experience, but I strongly believe we made the right choice.

Why do you want to work for Oxide?

My whole journey in the tech world has been driven by a passion for integrating hardware and software to create transformative user experiences, for creating tangible products for people I understand and want to make their lives better. Oxide's mission resonates with me, especially its emphasis on the harmonious integration of hardware and software.

Here are my 5 reasons why, revolving around yours:

1. **Kick butt:** Oxide's belief in the synergy between hardware and software aligns perfectly with my experiences and convictions. I'm excited to work on holistic cloud computer "experience," deliver real valuable innovation to real people. I want to kick the metaphysical butt of challenge, butt of discovery and butt of achievement. Three butts total.
2. **Have fun:** My happiest professional moments have been when I was part of a team that shared a collective vision, faced challenges head-on, and celebrated successes together. Oxide's emphasis on teamwork, transparency, and resilience aligns with my own experiences and aspirations. I really want to have fun and to love my job.
3. **Don't cheat:** My current role at Amazon Alexa ASR has been a learning experience, but it's also made me realize the importance of alignment between personal values and organizational culture. I see Oxide as an opportunity to contribute to a mission-driven company while also growing both personally and professionally. I don't like Amazon cheating, but even more I don't like to cheat myself staying in Amazon further.
4. **Love our customers:** I want to build products which change the lives of people (and organizations of people) for the better, and we can innovate and create on their behalf.
5. **Change Computing Forever:** Okay, last, but not least, being at the bleeding edge of computing sends a light shiver down my spine. I don't know if I can directly contribute, but I would like to help you, when you do.

Oxide's mission and values mirror my own professional journey and aspirations.

As a side note, I deeply liked the presentation and style of Oxide's whole package (site, messaging and discussion), it resonated with me and I thought "I would really like to work with these people, no matter how far we'll have to travel" and I caught a rare excitement inside, which helped me write these pages fully and honestly! Thanks for the opportunity to reflect and relive some of the moments.